job searches upon completing their training.

How many candidates have you trained?

We began with skill training programmes and have successfully trained many candidates. Since our inception, we have trained 130,000 candidates. Our efforts have primarily focused on sponsored programmes in collaboration with various ministries and state departments.

What career opportunities and support do your drone pilot training graduates receive upon completing the programme?

Over the last three months, I have observed individuals with just a 10th-grade education completing our five-day drone pilot training and securing jobs with salaries ranging from 20,000 to 25,000 per month, including accommodation and food. This is due to the rapidly evolving drone industry and the high demand for drone pilots. Students pay for the training, complete the five-day course, and then obtain jobs boasting a 100% placement rate. Additionally, some graduates pursue self-employment as micro-entrepreneurs. After completing the five-day training, they undergo an additional two to three days of agricultural spraying training to learn how to handle heavy drones. Following this, they can obtain financing from NBFCs to purchase a drone with our assistance. They then offer drone services to farmers, creating their own business opportunities.

What are the qualifications and assessment processes required by the DGCA to become a certified drone instructor?

According to DGCA regulations, candidates must be graduates, hold an RPC, and be RPI-certified. The DGCA, as the regulatory body, conducts rigorous viva and assessments for candidates aspiring to become instructors. This is a challenging examination process. Only those qualified by the DGCA can become instructors and must also have a certain amount of flying experience. We are hiring instructors and planning to develop our in-house ecosystem to create a pool of trainers, although this is still in the planning stages.

What is involved in generating RPC certificates?

For RPC certification, we train candidates and upload the necessary data, like their training assessment forms, skill training certificates, flying assessment forms, etc, to generate the certificates. This involves a structured process. Our responsibilities include mobilising the candidates and providing the training while the regulatory body oversees the certification process. It operates similarly to running a school, where everything must be available for regulatory inspections.

How do your courses address drone industry skills and entrepreneurship?

New startups are emerging in the drone industry. A major challenge within this ecosystem is identifying individuals skilled in drone assembly and maintenance. We offer drone assembly and technician courses and drone maintenance engineer courses to address this. These courses are aligned with NSQF standards and are conducted at our training centres. The courses require a minimum qualification of 10th or 12th standard pass out. We specifically select candidates who show a genuine interest in the drone industry, focusing on fostering micro-entrepreneurship. Similar to how many people opened mobile repair shops in the past, we foresee a future where individuals will establish drone repair shops, given the increasing use of drones across various industries. Currently, we offer four to five courses, providing training across India in 12 states with 70 centres operating these courses.

What is the process for obtaining a pilot certificate through your training programme?

Students must complete a set number of flying hours in the curriculum. Once these hours are completed, the details are submitted to Bharat Kosh, a portal where we generate a challan to issue a pilot certificate to the student. Additionally, we submit these details to the DGCA website. On the DGCA platform, you can see numerous remote pilot certificates generated online and offline.

What qualifications do you look for when hiring faculty for drone training?

We employ individuals who are graduates and have a minimum of 50 hours of instructional experience, particularly those with a background in agriculture. We prefer candidates with agricultural knowledge because they understand spraying techniques, pesticides, and soil fertility. This expertise is advantageous for our company, which manufactures agricultural drones, as they can effectively train others on the correct usage of pesticides, chemical handling, and application methods. Graduates with a farming background who meet the RPC and RPA requirements as per DGCA norms are ideal for our training and operational needs. We have around 20 instructors who work in rotational shifts. This allows us to allocate them efficiently according to our needs. EFY